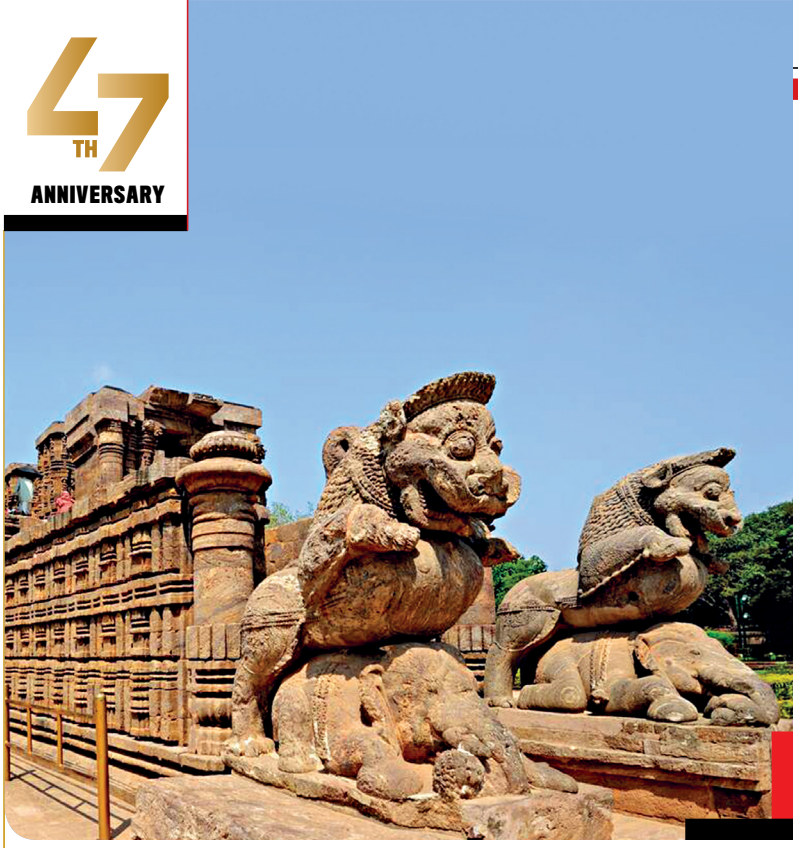


Konark

The Sun Temple at Konark is a humbling experience when compared to the arrogance of progress and technology. Just the explanation of what the chariot wheels of the temple signify and how they were conceptualised takes your breath away. The spokes of the chariot wheels break down to hours, minutes, seconds with a bewildering precision. When it had the full shikhara, the temple must have been mighty and grandiose. Even what remains is awe-inspiring. The sound-and-light show at the temple is excellent. And when you go to the beach, it's quiet and cosmic. There's a village en route—Balikondalo—where mud houses painted with beautiful frescoes make it an eternal sort of rural India.



PALLAVI PASRICHA

Khajuraho

When the West saw Khajuraho they said it is all about procreation and sexuality, but then through Shobita Punja's research and so on, we have got new eyes and come to know how it depicts the wedding of Shiva and Parvati. The details are stunning. For instance, there's a sculpture of a lady picking a thorn from her foot, in stone. The erotic sculptures at Khajuraho have humour in them, the absolute opposite of being coy and Victorian, which historical layering made us.

Tranquebar

In the early days of travel, it was all about travelling to see the difference. In the 21st century, you must also have a sense of unique discovery. That sense is total when the road that takes you to Tranquebar stops at the sea. You reach a dead end. You don't expect anything there. Then you start discovering the destination. Tranquebar has Tamil, Danish and British architecture. There are pretty, white tropical churches. The place is an interesting mixture of East and West. You will find people singing Christian hymns in Tamil. The first printing press of India was set up at Tranquebar and the first publication of the Bible in Tamil was done here. And it has the maxiyozone (maximum concentration of ozone) there to prolong your life.



–with Amit Dixit